



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Welcome to NUS!

Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute was born from the neighbourhood and grows through ongoing dialogue with it.

It is a space for research, learning, and exchange, where knowledge meets everyday life.

Open and engaged, the Institute connects people and ideas, building understanding through real experiences.

This guide helps communicate its identity with clarity and consistency.

The Brand Manual

Introduction

This document serves as the official manual for the correct use of the Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute trademark. The new visual identity, introduced in 2025 and designed specifically for the Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute, aims to clearly and consistently communicate the brand's values both inside and outside the organization.

Manual Usage Guide

Following the guidelines in this manual is essential to guarantee a recognizable, unified, and lasting identity. The rules presented here are not subject to personal interpretations or modifications; every element must be used respecting its function and context.

Legal Notes

The trademark is property of the Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute and represents a symbol of trust, quality, and integrity. For this reason, its use must always be consistent, precise, and faithful to the approved original digital files, which are available from the Institute's Communication Office.

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Introduction

The Institute
Our Story
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The Institute

Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute

is a research institute where theory meets practice, with the aim of transforming the places we live in. We study neighbourhoods, listen to the voices of their inhabitants, and imagine new forms of community.

From theoretical courses like *Urban Law*, *History of Modern Subcultures* and *Vernacular Languages* to practical labs like *Food Sustainability* and *Urban Design*, the Institute embraces an inclusive, sustainability-focused approach attentive to space, materials and methods.



The Institute

Study Program

Our program spans three years, blending theory, hands-on experience, and a strong focus on urban and social contexts.

It starts with an optional English prep course, designed to help students ease into their studies.

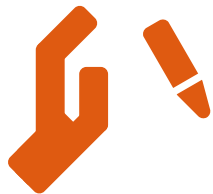
- I The first year lays the groundwork: vernacular languages, cultural psychology, sustainability, urban law, and inclusive design.
- II In the second year, students explore community dynamics territorial analysis, with labs on event planning, circular economy, cultural mediation, and urban design.
- III The third year is all about change-making: students dive into urban regeneration, ecological architecture, urban farming, and community development.

We prepare students to imagine and help build more inclusive, sustainable, and equitable cities.



The Institute

We prepare our students for three main professional roles:



URBANISTS

For those interested in designing spaces that respond to the needs of contemporary society, this path integrates environmental awareness with cultural sensitivity in spatial planning.



SOCIAL WORKERS

Ideal for students eager to address social challenges, this program focuses on fostering inclusion and enhancing individual and community well-being.



MEDIATORS

Tailored for those passionate about languages and intercultural dialogue, this path equips students to bridge communication gaps between diverse communities and local institutions.

Our Story

**Neighbourhood Urban
Studies Institute
was born
in the neighborhood,
for the neighborhood.**



Our Places

NUS was born with an international vision, aiming to open campuses in several European cities. Each campus will be located in strategic neighborhoods—vibrant places full of connections—where students can closely observe social dynamics and begin to take action while studying.

The campus spaces will always be surrounded by greenery and designed with dedicated buildings, created to foster learning, sharing, and connection with the local community.

Our Campus

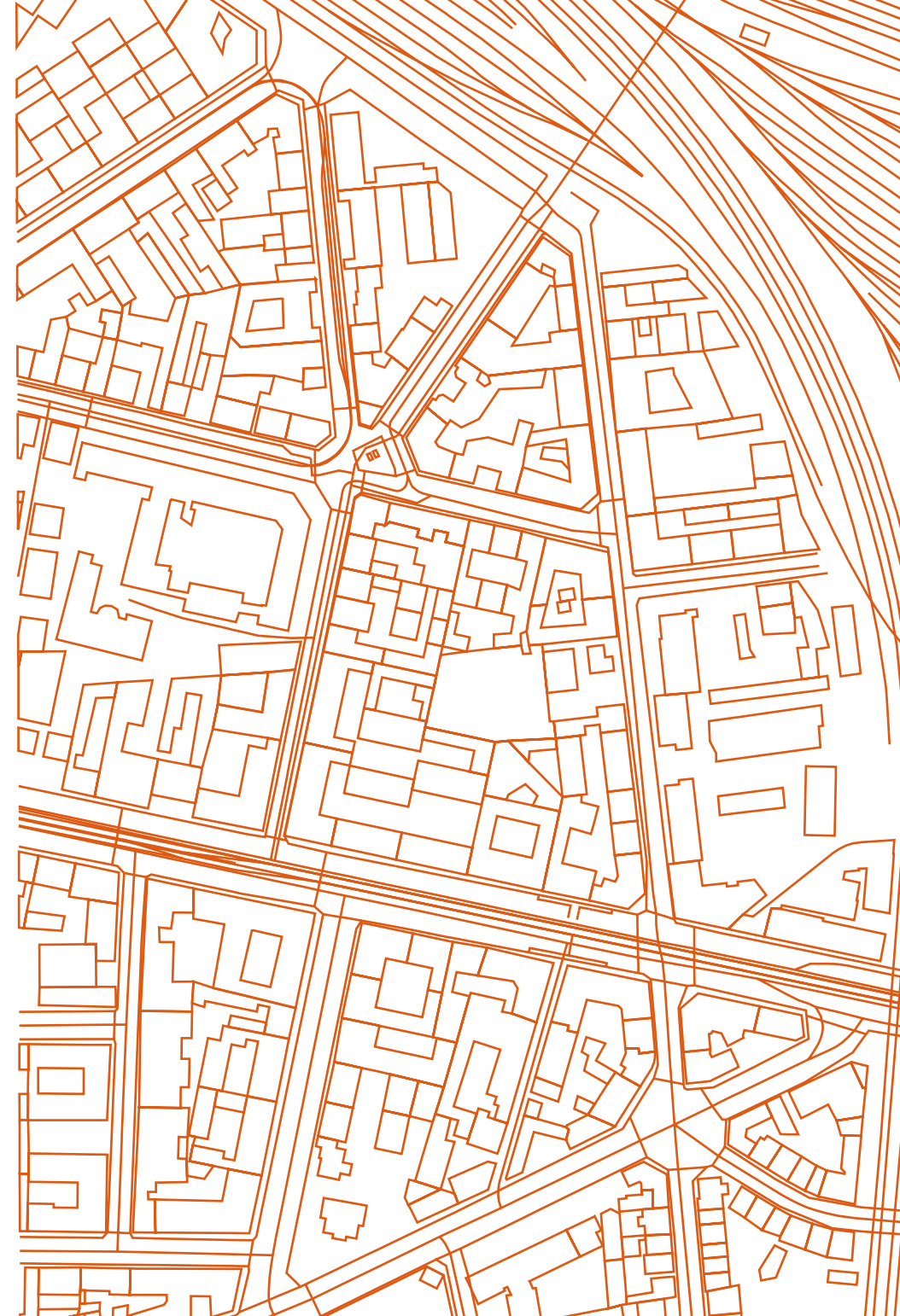
NoLo

The Institute's first campus is in NoLo, a vibrant neighbourhood north of Loreto in Milan.

Milan was chosen for its rich cultural diversity, which offers great opportunities but also real challenges. We want our students to engage with these complex realities from the start, preparing them for their future careers.

NoLo is a young, dynamic area welcoming new communities with specific needs. Here, students can learn by observing and interacting with the city's diverse neighbourhoods.

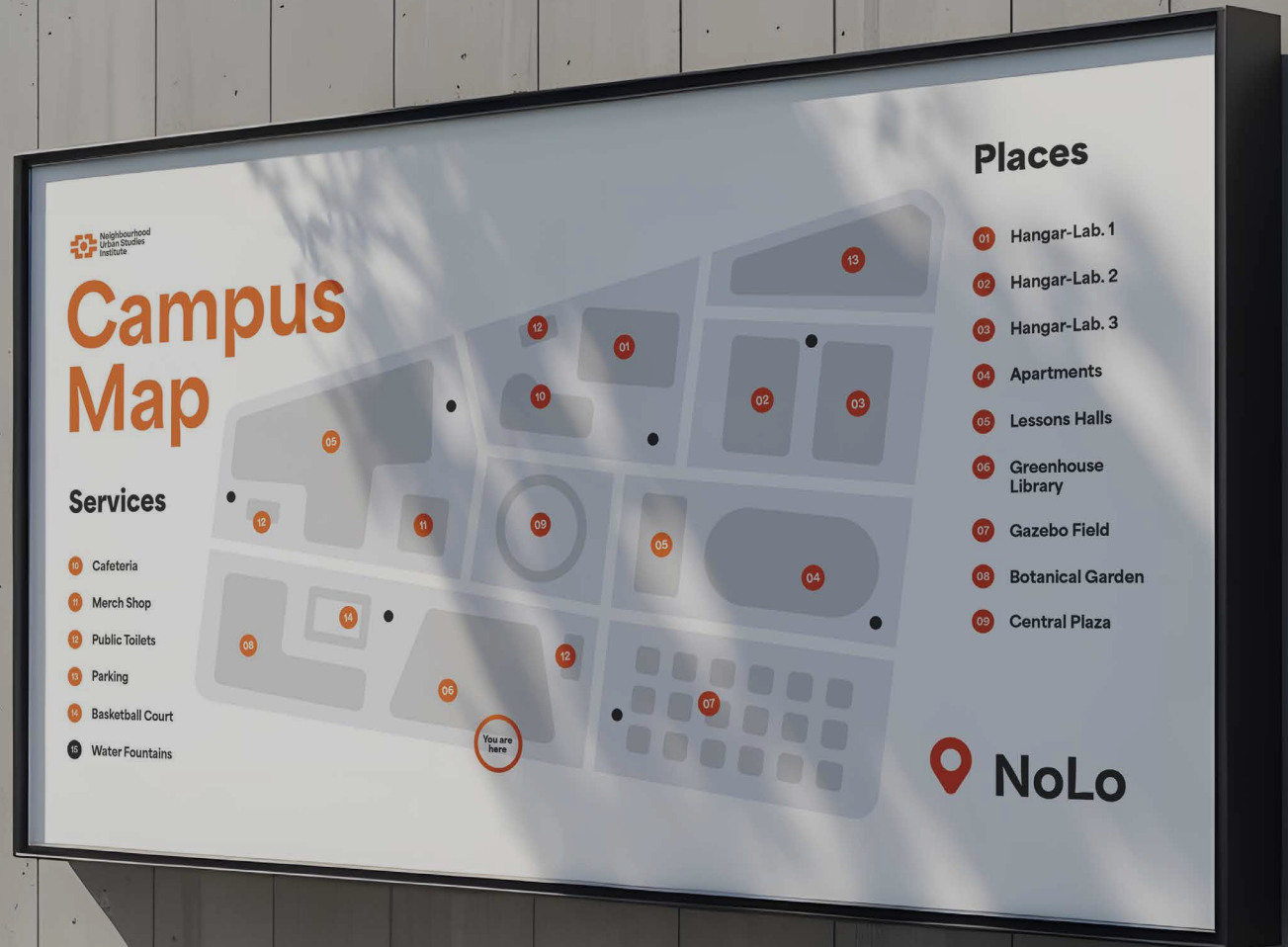
Our graduates will be ready to study and actively work on the territory from day one, putting theory into practice.



Our Campus

The campus includes a series of buildings designed to foster a student community used to living and working together.

Key features include the Seed Library and the Central Plaza – a central space and the beating heart of the Institute, where people come together.



Our Essence

**We shape shared
futures by grounding
knowledge in place,
people, and purpose.**

NUS is a place to understand communities and become part of one.

Naming

Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute

NUS

The abbreviated version of the name may be used exclusively in informal contexts where it is more practical to avoid writing or pronouncing the institute's full name.

A common example is the website link (www.nus.com).

Furthermore, this version must never be used in conjunction with the official logo.



Our Payoff

Make future a shared place.

The word “make” is not random, it’s used to emphasize the idea that a shared future is possible just with a **collective** effort.



Our Mission

To make practical and theoretical tools available to people, enabling them to understand and value the communities in which they will operate.

Our Vision

**We believe in a society
that cooperates
in a synergic way,
in which everyone
collaborates actively
for common well-being.**

Our Values



Authenticity

Feeling part of something means seeing yourself in others, in places and in shared stories. It means knowing that “we” comes before “I.”



Solidarity

Those who live together, respond together. A community’s true strength is revealed in how it remains united.



Belonging

What truly matters comes from what is real. Identity isn’t something you construct – it reveals itself, if you know how to listen.



Concreteness

Ideas don’t remain abstract. They take shape, becoming actions, spaces, and tangible change.

Positioning

The Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute is a valid alternative to a Master's Degree, a Research Master, and ITS programs for graduates in Psychology, Healthcare Professions, and Urban Planning/Architecture.

Brand Architecture

The brand architecture follows a second-level monolithic model.

The university presents itself as a single brand, even when engaging in diverse activities—such as charitable initiatives supporting the local neighbourhood.

Within this brand architecture, each secondary activity has its own mark, always paired with university's logotype, ensuring consistency and recognizability across the visual identity system.

Personality

Welcoming

Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute was born from the neighborhood and grows through ongoing dialogue with it. It is a space for research, learning, and exchange, where knowledge meets everyday life.

Open and engaged, the Institute connects people and ideas, building understanding through real experiences.



2

Basic Elements

Trademark
Color
Typography
Visual Identifier
Pictograms
Photography

Trademark

The brand is built around a dynamic visual identity system designed to foster inclusion and a strong sense of belonging within the university community. While embracing flexibility and openness, it always stays true to the core values that define the Institute.

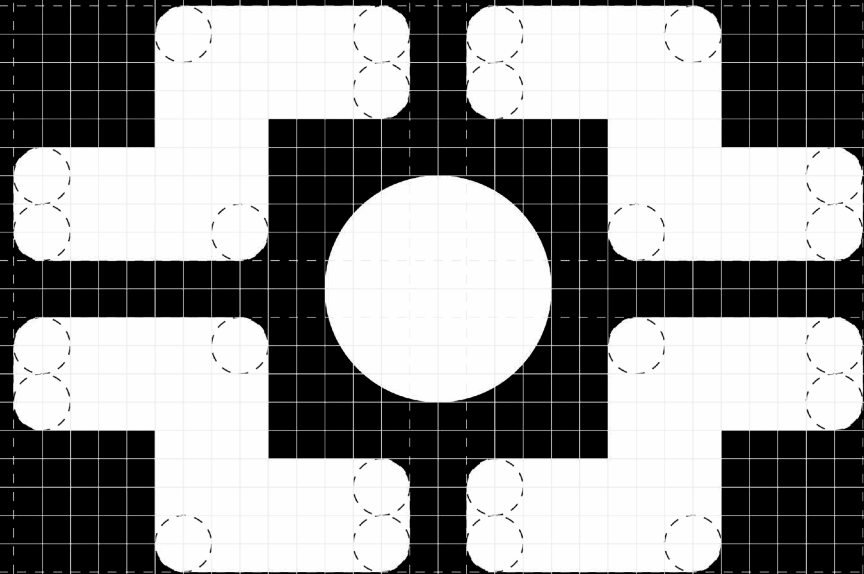
Each element in the system is thoughtfully designed to align with the others, forming a unified and consistent brand expression.

At the heart of it all is the first – and most important – element: the trademark.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Trademark
**Emblem Technical
Construction**



The emblem depicts a bird's-eye view of a neighborhood intersection leading to a central square, symbolizing community gathering. Designed using a modular grid based on a circle, the emblem's shapes are all derived from this element. The emblem is never used alone and must always appear alongside the logotype.

Trademark
Technical Construction

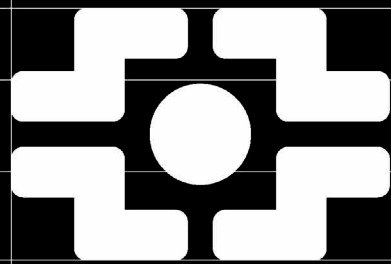


The module is defined by the inner circle of the emblem. Using this as a reference, the logotype spans 7 modules in length, with a spacing of half a module between the logotype and the emblem.

The logotype's line spacing is precisely calibrated to prevent typographic inconsistencies and to ensure optimal readability.

Trademark
Clear Space

Using the reference
module, the necessary
spacing was calculated
to establish the brand's
clear space.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Trademark

Usage version



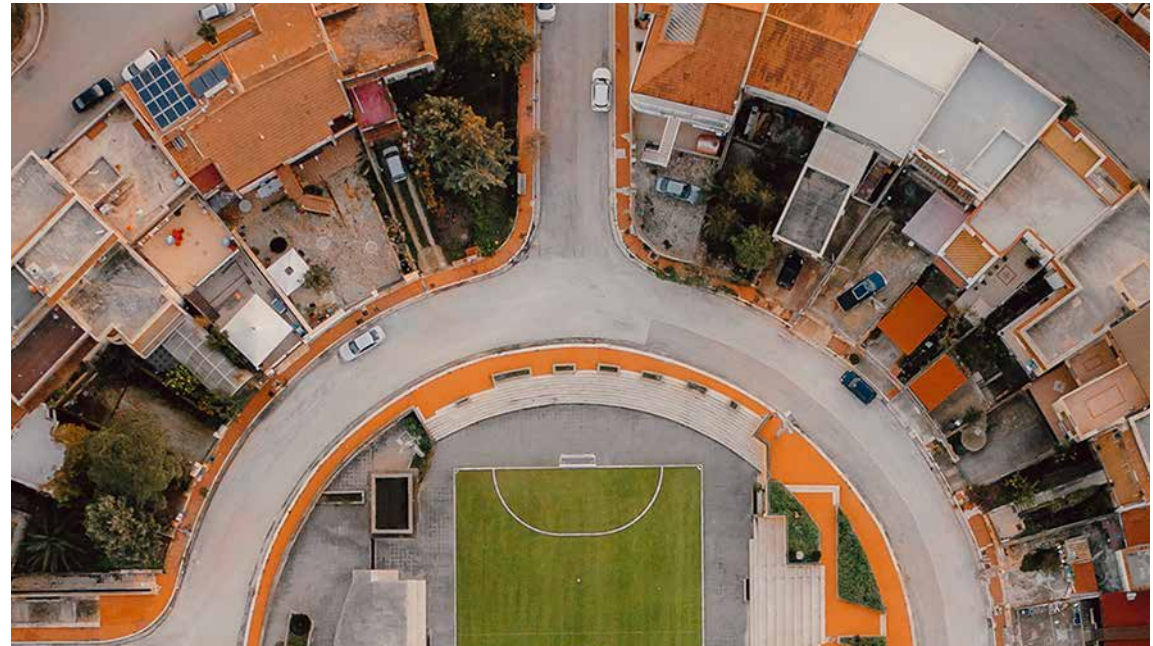
The trademark uses three main colors: Brick Orange, White and Black.

In the positive version (1), the emblem appears in Brick Orange and the logotype in black, on a white background.

In reversed versions (2), or in solid background applications (3) – where Brick Orange is the only background color allowed – these colors alternate to maintain visual consistency and readability.



Trademark
**Usage version
with photography
background**



When using photographic backdrop, the image must be adjusted to ensure the logo remains clear and easily legible—this can include enhancing dark tones.

This is also the only case in which both elements of the trademark—the emblem and the logotype—may appear in white, to improve readability.



Trademark Misuses

Examples and Rules to
Maintain Brand Integrity



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
use the emblem without
the logotype.

Do not
use the logotype without
the emblem.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
modify the horizontal
alignment of the
elements.



NUS

Do not
place the acronym
alongside the emblem in
any configuration.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
replace the logotype's
font.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
change the orientation of
the emblem.

**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**



Do not
reverse the horizontal
arrangement of the
elements.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
alter the proportions
between the brand
elements.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
distort the logo in any
way.



**Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute**

Do not
rotate the logo in any way.

Trademark

Misuses - color

Examples and Rules to
Maintain Brand Integrity



Do not
change the color of the
content; use only the
approved color versions.



Do not
apply color gradients.



Do not
apply outlines.



Do not
insert images of all types
indiscriminately.

Color

Color is organized into a system of identifying tones, consisting of one primary, three secondary colors, one neutral, plus black and white. Each tone is inspired by natural or man-made elements that characterize the neighborhoods and is assigned a specific name linked to its original context.



BRICK ORANGE

RGB	223	89	17	CMYK	6%	75%	100%	1%
HSL	0.06	0.86	0.47	XYZ	34.1050	22.8732	3.1478	
HSV	21°	92°	87°	Yxy	22.8732	0.5672	0.3804	



CITY SKY BLUE

RGB	204	224	236	CMYK	24%	6%	6%	0%
HSL	0.56	0.46	0.86	XYZ	66.6978	72.2048	89.7785	
HSV	203°	14°	93°	Yxy	72.2048	0.2917	0.315	



LEAF LIME

RGB	233	234	241	CMYK	26%	18%	100%	0%
HSL	0.65	0.22	0.93	XYZ	78.9043	82.5201	94.9884	
HSV	233°	3°	95°	Yxy	82.5201	0.3077	0.3218	



FOREST GREEN

RGB	23	51	56	CMYK	91%	63%	59%	58%
HSL	0.53	0.42	0.15	XYZ	2.2510	2.8353	4.1700	
HSV	189°	59°	22°	Yxy	2.8353	0.2432	0.3063	



CONCRETE GREY

RGB	233	234	241	CMYK	10%	7%	4%	0%
HSL	0.65	0.22	0.93	XYZ	78.9043	82.5201	94.9884	
HSV	233°	3°	95°	Yxy	82.5201	0.3077	0.3218	

Color

Extended primary color system

A secondary range
of shades is derived
from the primary color,
adjusted through varying
levels of opacity.

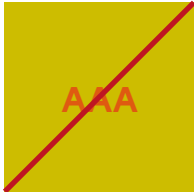
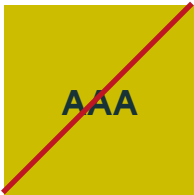
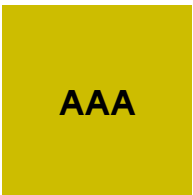
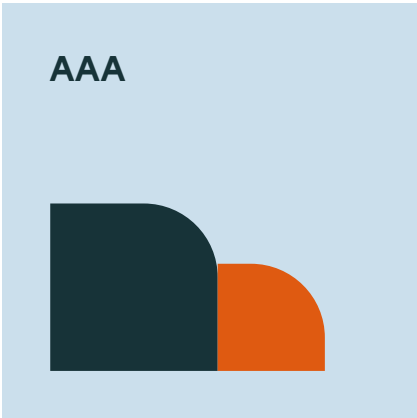
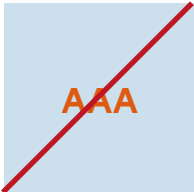
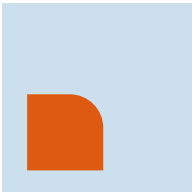
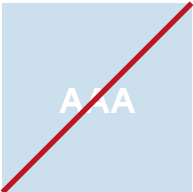
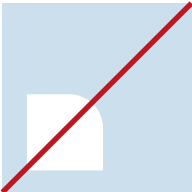
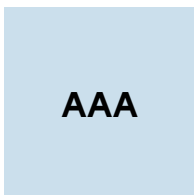
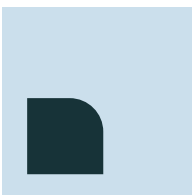
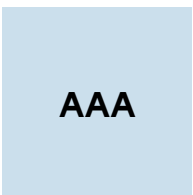
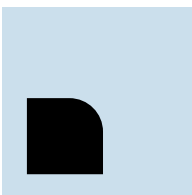
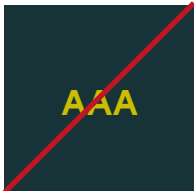
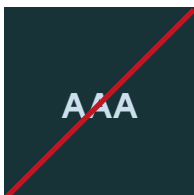
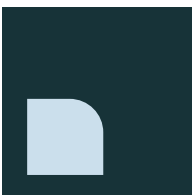
Color Accessibility

To meet visual accessibility standards, only the specified color combinations should be used.



Color
Accessibility

To meet visual
accessibility standards,
only the specified color
combinations should
be used.

Typography

The brand's typographic system is built around two fonts from the same type family: Area.

The two styles, Area Inktrap and Area Normal, provide accessibility, visual consistency, and a strong sense of identity.

Typography plays a key role in shaping the brand's tone and is also featured in the trademark itself.

Aa

Aa

Typography

Area Inktrap

Area Inktrap is the brand's primary font. It's used for both headings and body text thanks to its flexibility.

This sans-serif typeface includes inktraps—small cutouts placed in areas where ink tends to accumulate during printing. These details improve readability and help prevent smudging.

Area Inktrap is a strong visual marker and contributes significantly to the brand's recognizability.

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee
Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk
Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp
Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv
Ww Xx Yy Zz

0123456789
.,;:!?'"()[]{}@#\$
%&*+=-

Typography
Area Normal

Area Normal is designed for longer texts and content meant for continuous reading.

Its clean design and excellent legibility make it ideal for both print materials and digital environments. It supports the reading experience without ever weighing down the content.

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee
Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk
Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp
Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv
Ww Xx Yy Zz

0123456789
.,,:!?"'()[]{}@#\$
%&*+=-

Typography

Hierarchy

The text layout follows simple, functional rules designed to ensure clarity, visual consistency, and easy readability in every context.

Proportions between titles, subtitles, and body text are carefully balanced to maintain a clear visual hierarchy.

All textual elements are left-aligned, while longer texts may be justified—as long as left alignment remains the reference point. Centered, vertical, or rotated text should be avoided.

Bold is used for titles and key messages, while italics are reserved for brief emphasis within body copy. Line spacing is adjusted according to content: it matches the font size in titles and follows a classic rhythm in longer paragraphs.

Together, these principles create a text system that is organized, accessible, and aligned with the Institute's welcoming identity.

Sample text

Living the Neighborhood, Shaping the Future

Open Day 2025
The Institute that Grows with the City

Anissinisdiaibus,etvolutiussolentomnimoillorrest,offictibus.
Ant magnis am, occumquaecea sunt, odigniendel eosanda ilit
fuga. Itatect iaspel moluptam quuntiam labo. Temped quiata
aut ius re num sus, sitaten imporeium andandent vercienda
sin porepereprae nonem simaxim inctet quas asin eate auda
ditatis nobisin cimilit eatias re nobitae. Ut qui con nis sequi
dolorem alit minulparia alitiur aceati omnia vent qui berum
faceperum as simolla nossimus abore inverias ex eos imus
maximaximod quo escipient doluptis enectat ibusdandem
fuga. Ucil et ea veles escia quam nonsequaest harum res
eum am hil es dellori assimenis venditae ne et omnimus, int.

Visual Identifier

The visual coefficient is a graphic element that, when used alongside the other components of the brand identity, helps define the brand's visual space in a distinctive yet flexible way.

This element's versatility strengthens brand recognition even when the logo is not present, thanks to visual cues that remain aligned with the core identity system.

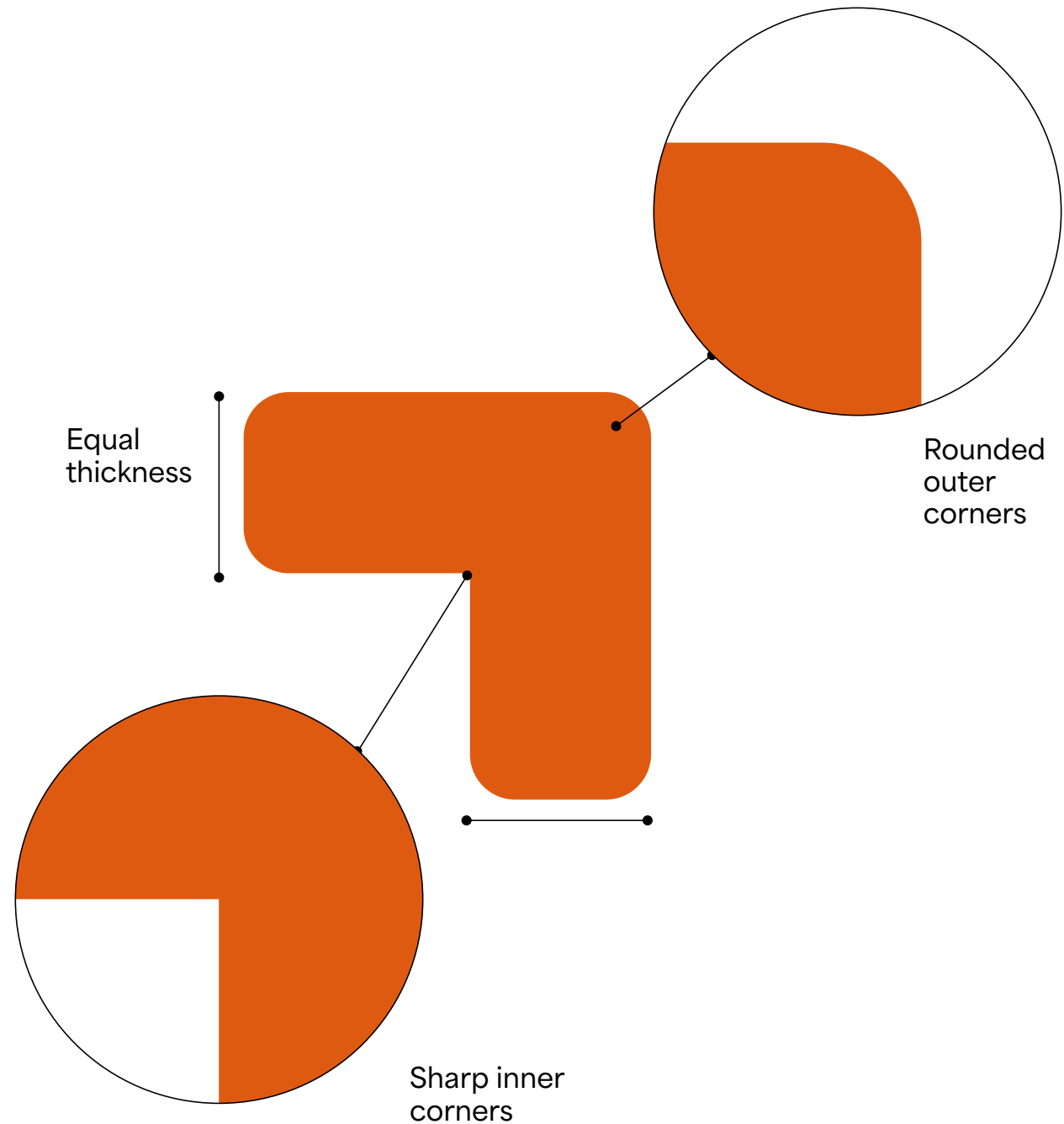
Its modular and dynamic nature symbolically represents movement and progression, evoking the paths and connections that shape neighborhood life – a central theme in the institute's identity.



Visual Identifier

Basic Elements

It is derived from the formal elements of the logo, replicating line thickness, rounded corners, and consistent geometries. The spacing between curves must also align with the original design to ensure visual consistency.

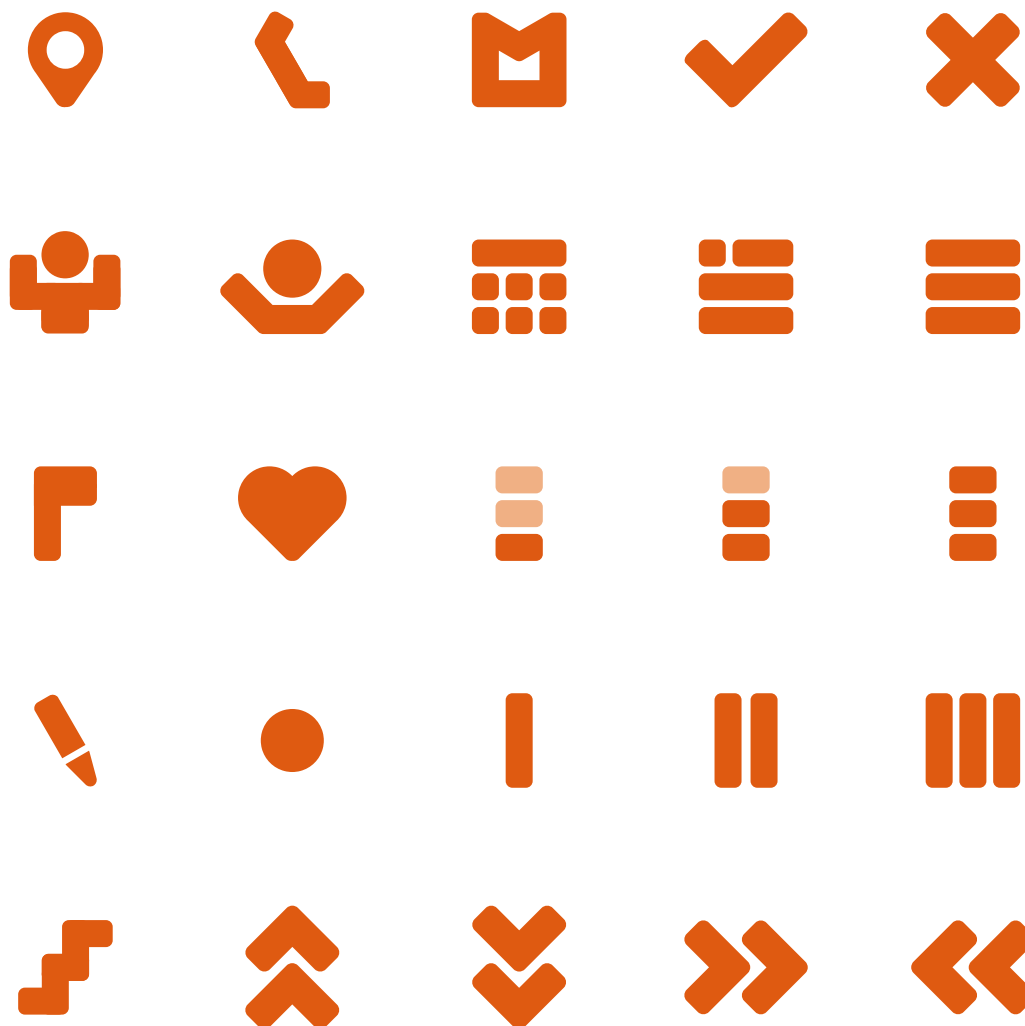


Pictograms

Il sistema di pittogrammi è progettato per avere icone utili per la comunicazione offline, la comunicazione online e la segnaletica.

Le forme sono state costruite partendo dall'emblema e dal suo modulo, il cerchio.

Ne risulta che tutti gli elementi hanno stesso spessore, stessi angoli arrotondati e spigoli.



Photography

Images should reflect the brand's values, which is why they must be carefully created and selected, highlighting key elements such as inclusivity and other distinctive traits.

They may also express values not explicitly stated by the brand, as long as they remain consistent with its personality and identity.

We pay special attention to images featuring people and neighborhood spaces, as these are the two core pillars of the institution.

Photography Style

The style should remain as clean and minimal as possible, avoiding unnecessary elements that may cause distraction. This approach helps highlight the core content of the image and, when present, brings focus to people—who represent the narrative and relational heart of the communication.



Shooting

Images created specifically for particular communication and institutional needs.

They are generally produced internally and also serve as an image bank representing the identity of teaching staff and collaborators.



Non-professional

Images created by third parties (e.g., students) that follow the guidelines and can be used for communication purposes (never for institutional use).



Photo database

Images created for all types of communication.

Photography Language

The visual language should strongly emphasize the values of concreteness and authenticity.

Specifically, creating images using Artificial Intelligence software is prohibited. We believe there is plenty to capture in the streets and among people, without the need for AI-generated images.



Style

Avoid staged settings, situations or subjects. Unless part of an organized shoot, people should appear authentic and natural.



Brightness

Images should be bright with natural colors. Avoid heavy editing and the use of flash.



Subjects

While human presence is preferred, avoid crowds, confusion or clutter. Images should feel well-balanced.

Context

The subject should be placed in a clear and recognizable context.

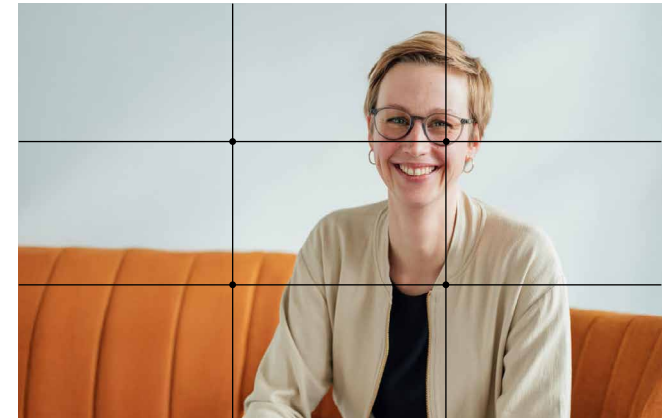
Photography **Cropping and Framing**

Images of environments and those featuring subjects may have different characteristics depending on the content. However, to ensure visual consistency, it is essential to follow the guidelines below.



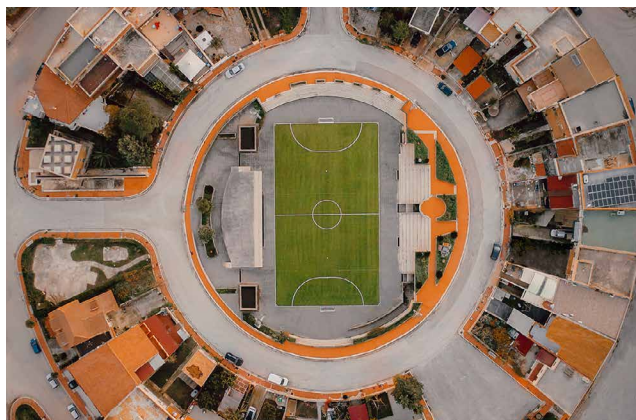
Composition

It is recommended to use the rule of thirds to create visually balanced and appealing images.



Composition

People should be positioned centrally within the composition.



Environment shots

Preferred angles include top-down, frontal, and varying heights to provide a complete view of the space.

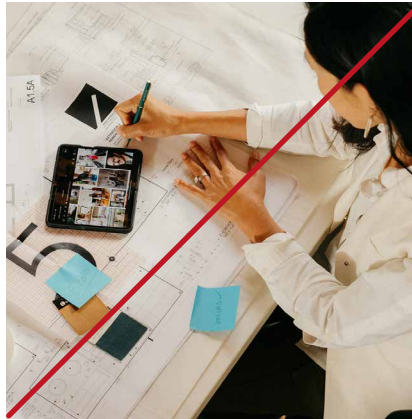


People shots

Frontal or slightly angled shots are ideal to ensure a natural look. Avoid low or high-angle shots.

Photography **DONTS**

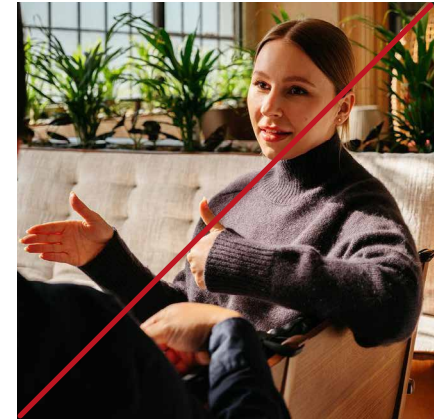
Examples and rules of images to avoid.



Do not use images featuring overhead shots or solitary subjects seen from behind.



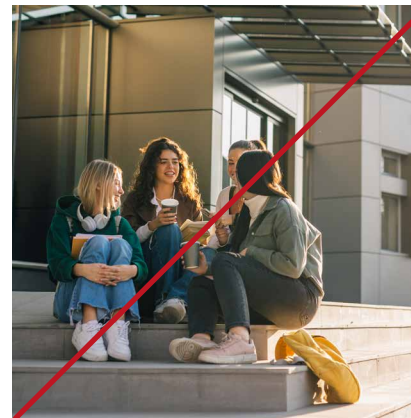
Do not use posed portraits that appear unnatural.



Do not use images with overly saturated colors or altered with filters.



Do not use group shots taken from above.



Do not use stock or inauthentic images of students, or those featuring stereotypes of any kind.



Do not use images with predominantly dark tones or low brightness.

Photography **DONTS**

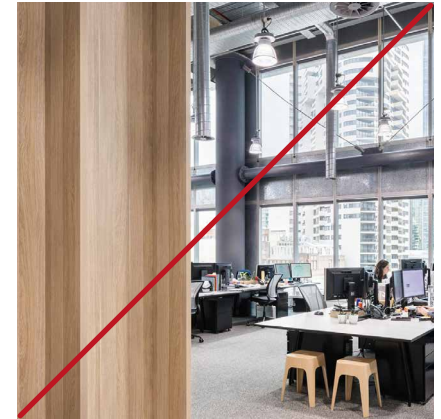
Examples and rules of images to avoid.



Do not use stock images to represent concepts, values or ideals.



Do not use images of close-up and partially cropped objects. Always avoid using zoom.



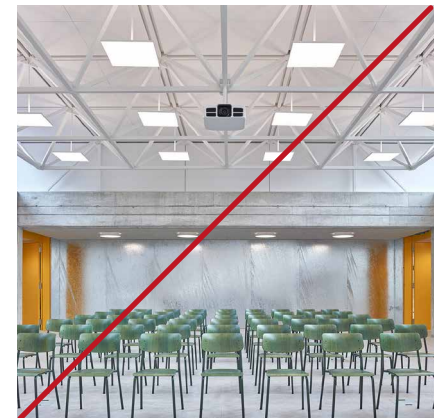
Do not use images with foreground objects that create depth or obstruct the view.



Do not use high-angle or distant views of the building's exterior.



Do not use low-angle views of the building's exterior.



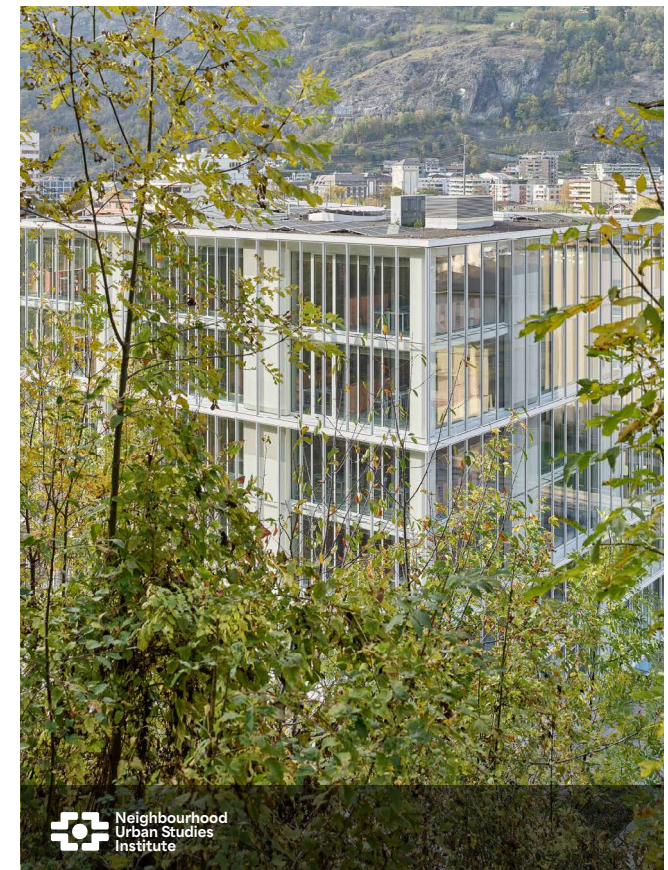
Do not use images with large empty spaces.

Photography

Trademark-to-image relationship

In most cases, especially during photo shoots, the trademark should be placed in the top left corner of the image.

In exceptional cases with particular subjects, the logo may be placed in the bottom left corner, still following the rules outlined so far.



3

Brand Marks

Signage
Stationery
Gadget
Merch
Website

Signage
Directions



Stationery
Business Card



Stationery
Letterhead

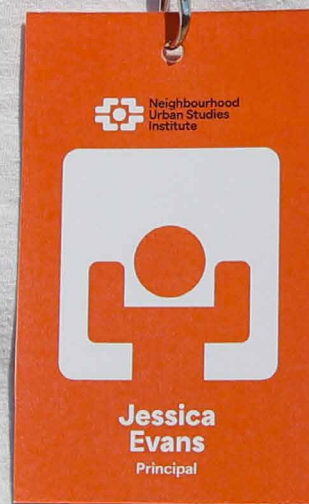


Neighbourhood
Urban Studies
Institute

Neighbourhood Urban
Studies Institute - NUS
NOLO Campus
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segreteria.nolo@nus.it



Stationery
Badge



Stationary
Brochure



Stationary **UrbanPad**

The UrbanPad is the ideal notebook for taking notes during explorations and inspections in neighbourhood areas.

Part of the WelcomeKit, it invites students to thoughtfully observe and listen to the residents of the neighbourhood from the very beginning.



Gadget **NUS Keychain**

The NUS Keychain is made of five modular pieces that form the brand emblem when assembled.

Each student receives one random piece in the WelcomeKit, symbolizing the importance of building friendships and collaboration throughout their time at NUS to complete the keychain.



Gadget Stickers



NUS stickers feature original illustrations created by a street artist from the NoLo neighborhood, integrated into selected pictograms from the visual identity.

Merch **NUS Tote**

The NUS Tote is a handcrafted canvas bag made from recycled fabrics, designed with two front pockets to hold essential student items. It is available in three interior colors, each representing a different field of study: Leaf Lime for social workers, City Sky Blue for mediators, and Forest Green for urban planners.

The tote is given upon enrollment and includes the UrbanPad, the SeedsKit and the NUS keychain – together forming the free WelcomeKit provided to new students selecting labs.



Merch
Seeds Kit



4

Communication

Offline Communication
Online Communication

Offline Communication

NUS offline communication relies mainly on posters. Flyers are not produced, except for the multilingual informational brochure, as the institute is invested to minimizing paper use in order to reduce environmental impact.

All printed materials are produced exclusively on recycled paper.

Offline Communication Poster

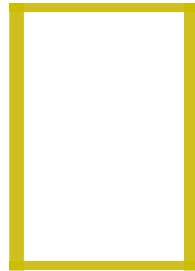
The posters feature a clean and minimal design.
The visual coefficient is also present here, this time incorporating an image.

The color may vary depending on the type and content of the poster.

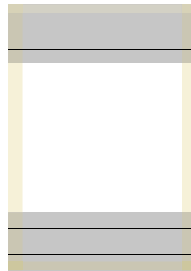


Offline Communication

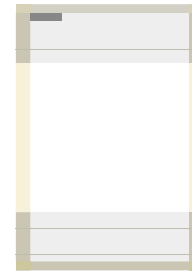
Poster format guidelines



1
Define the layout margins.



2
Create two bands for the event name and the date and description.



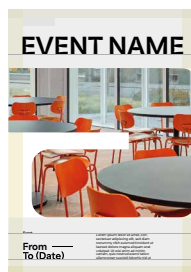
3
Reserve the top left corner for the trademark.



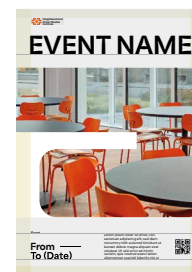
4
Place text following the predefined hierarchy and typographic rules.



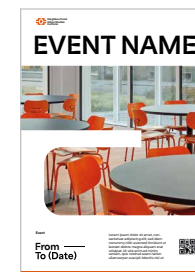
5
Insert the visual coefficient between the two bands.



6
Apply a clipping mask to the visual coefficient using an image relevant to the poster's content.



7
Add secondary elements (QR code, partner logos) in the empty areas left.



8
Add a bottom border in a color that matches the topic and overall poster color.

Online Communication

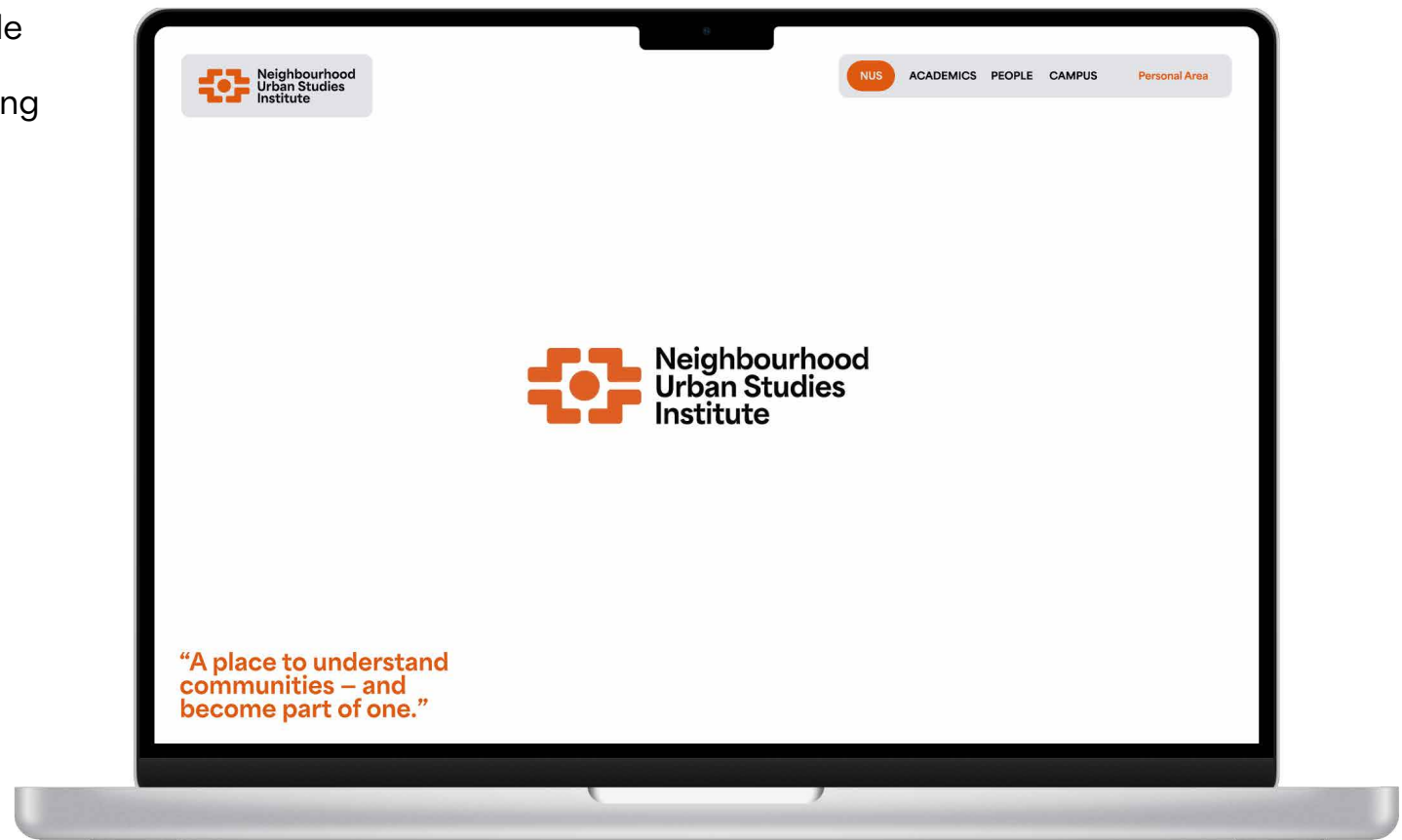
Online communication is a key element for NUS, and it is important to maintain a consistent tone across all digital channels.

Online Communication

NUS website

The website, accessible at www.nus.com, has been designed following all the guidelines outlined so far, with minor adjustments to adapt the elements for the digital environment.

If any changes are needed, it is essential to adhere to the rules to maintain consistency across all communication channels.



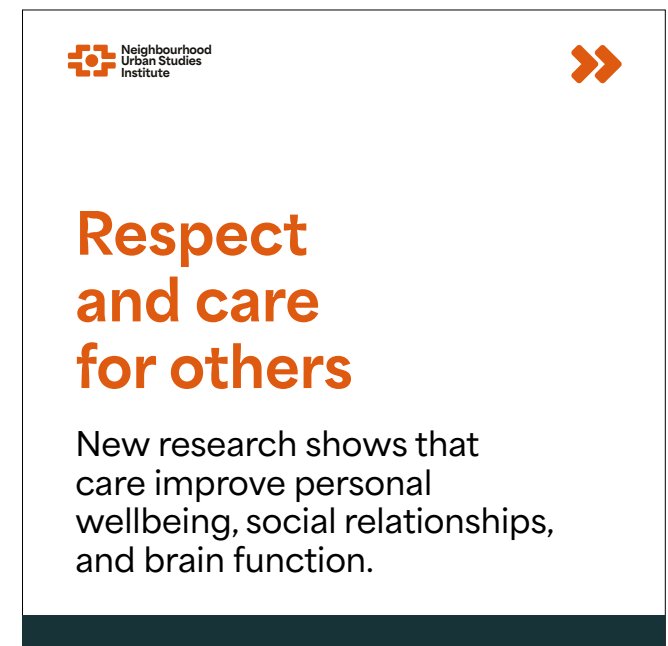
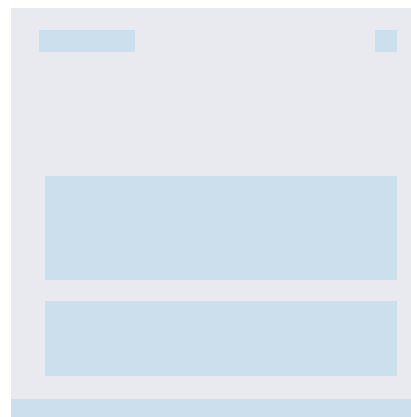
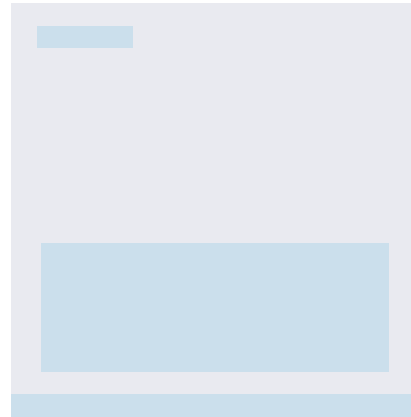
Online Communication

Post format guidelines

When the post doesn't contain text, it's better to use an image accompanied by a big title. Additional informations should be included in a scrollable post (carousel).

All posts within the same carousel must maintain visual consistency.

If the post include text (which should remain minimal), it is preferable to use a solid background, ideally in a neutral color. Text must follow the pre-defined typographic rules and the trademark must appear on every page of the content.





Neighbourhood Urban Studies Institute



POLITECNICO
MILANO 1863

Politecnico di Milano
Scuola del Design
Lab di Corporate Identity
A.A. 2024-2025

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